

USER GUIDE

Scripture Alone Bible

Everything the app can do, and how to set it up the way you want it.



For iPhone, iPad, Mac and Apple Watch · Version 1.1

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Welcome

Scripture Alone is a Bible for studying God's word without anything in the way: no ads, no trackers, no account and no server holding your data.

The whole Bible lives on your device, so the app reads offline, anywhere, from the moment it installs. The New American Standard Bible — NASB 2020 is built in and is what the app opens to. Everything else you add — other Bibles, commentary, the original languages — downloads once and then works offline too.

Your highlights, notes and favorites sync between your own devices through your private iCloud. Nobody else, including the developer, can see them.

WHERE THINGS ARE

Across the top of the reader: **Notes** and **Study** on the left, the passage title in the middle (tap it to go anywhere), and on the right the translation (**NASB**) and **Aa** for appearance and settings. Along the bottom: previous chapter, auto-scroll, **Listen** and next chapter. On a Mac the same buttons sit together in the window's toolbar.

The languages it speaks

The app follows your device's language. Besides English it speaks Simplified Chinese, Japanese, German, French, Spanish, Korean, Brazilian Portuguese and Italian, and each comes with a whole Bible of its own (和合本, 文語訳, Lutherbibel 1912, Louis Segond, Reina-Valera 1909, 개역 한글, Bíblia Livre and Riveduta), downloaded the first time it's needed. Any Bible can be read in any language.

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Reading

Open the app and you're reading. Everything else is a tap away, and nothing gets in front of the text until you ask for it.

Turning pages

- Scroll through a chapter; at its end, keep going or tap the next chapter's link.
- Use the arrows in the bottom bar for the previous and next chapter (⌂ and ⌂) on a keyboard).
- On a wide screen — an iPhone on its side, an iPad, a wide Mac window — a chapter is laid out in two columns like a printed Bible. Swipe to turn the page, or use the arrow keys, space bar or trackpad.

Hands-free

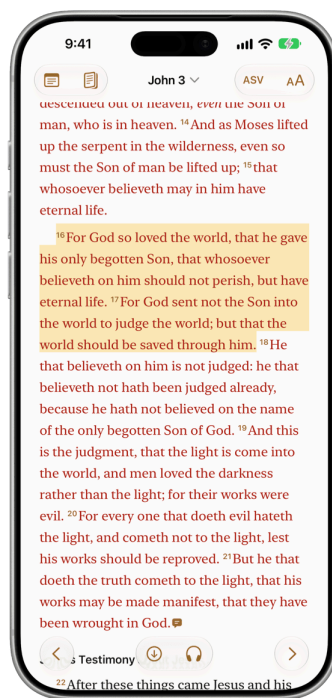
Tap **Auto-Scroll** in the bottom bar and the chapter moves on by itself, into the next chapter when it ends. Touch and hold it to pick a speed: Slow, Relaxed, Steady or Brisk.

Footnotes and the words of Christ

Tap a footnote mark to read the note. The words of Christ are in red, poetry is set as poetry, and section headings are shown — each can be turned off under **Aa**.

Selecting verses

Tap a verse to select it; tap more verses to add them. A bar appears with everything you can do with them:



The reader

Button	What it does
Colored dots	Highlight in one of five colors. The eraser removes a highlight.
Heart	Add the verses to your Favorites.
Pencil	Write a note on them.
Copy	Copy the verses with their reference.
Share	Share as a designed image, text or a link.
Book with a character	Original Languages: the verse word by word in Hebrew or Greek (one verse at a time).
Listen	Read the selection aloud.
×	Clear the selection.

PUBLISHER LIMITS

Some translations limit how much may be copied or shared at once. When you go past a limit, the app tells you whose limit it is and how many verses it allows.

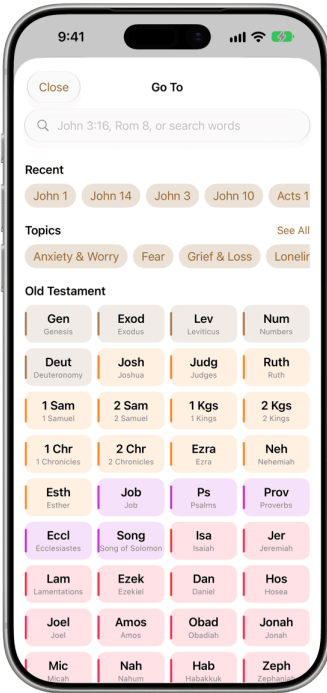
Comparing translations

Tap the translation button (top right) and choose **Compare Translations...** to read a passage in several translations side by side.

3

Getting around

Tap the passage title at the top — or press **⌘L** on a keyboard — to open Go To. One box does everything.



Go To

Type a reference

Write it the way you'd jot it down. All of these work:

- **jn 3 16** — John 3:16
- **rom 8:28-39** — a range
- **1co13** — a whole chapter
- **ps 23, Genesis 1, rev 21:4**

Search for words

Type a word or a phrase to search the translation you're reading. Bibles on your device search offline, phrases included.

Browse

Or pick a book, then a chapter. The chapters you've read recently and the searches you've run wait at the top, ready to open again.

Topics: what the Bible says about what you're going through

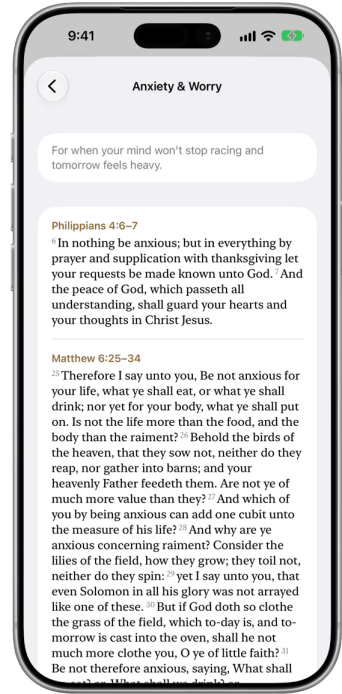
Go To has a row of Topics — Anxiety & Worry, Fear, Grief & Loss, Loneliness and more.

See All opens all 72, in seven groups, from Depression & Despair and Guilt & Shame to Marriage, Parenting, Work, Waiting and God's Presence.

Each topic gathers a dozen or so well-loved passages, shown in the translation you're reading. Tap one to go there; touch and hold to favorite, copy or share it.

You don't have to know a topic's name: type how you feel — "anxious", "lonely", "burned out" — and the matching topic is offered above the verses, in any of the app's languages.

In English, the directory also holds **Nave's Topical Bible** from A to Z: more than 5,000 topics, every passage a link.



Topics

IF YOU'RE STRUGGLING

A search that sounds like someone thinking of ending their life shows a card first, with a crisis line for your country you can call or text, and passages of hope. If you're in danger, please call your local emergency number.

Your Bibles

Tap the translation button at the top right to switch Bibles.
Manage Translations... at the bottom of that menu is where you add, download and remove them.

Included with the app

Translation	How you get it
New American Standard Bible — NASB 2020	BUILT IN On your device from the moment the app installs, Apple Watch included.
NASB 1995	Downloads once, the first time you choose it.
American Standard Version (ASV), Berean Standard Bible (BSB), King James Version (KJV)	Download once, the first time you choose one. Public domain.
A Bible in your own language	Downloads at first launch when your device uses one of the app's other eight languages.

Once downloaded, a Bible reads and searches offline for good.

Add a translation

In **Manage Translations...**, under **Add a Translation**, there are three ways in:

1 Browse Free Translations...

lists the openly licensed Bibles on eBible.org, starting with the ones in your own languages

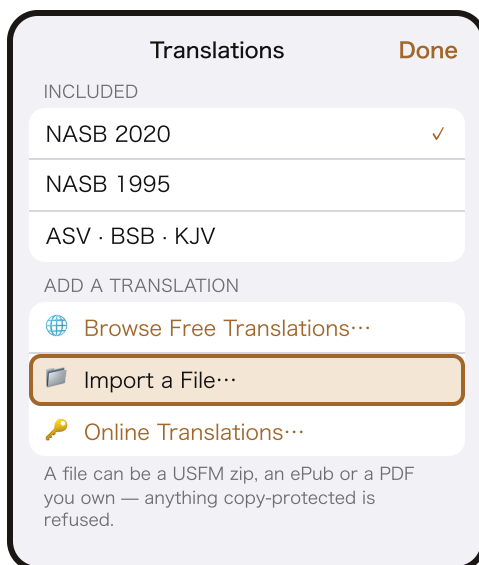
(**Other Languages** shows the rest — hundreds of them). Tap one to download it. Nothing is fetched until you tap.

2 Import a File... brings in a

Bible you own: a **USFM zip**, a **DRM-free ePub** or a **PDF with real text** in it (not a scan). The next pages say more.

3 Online Translations... reads

the ESV, CSB or NKJV over the network with your own free key. See chapter 5.



Importing a Bible you own

Reading a whole Bible takes a minute or two — longer for a study Bible or a PDF. When it's done, a summary shows what came in: every book, any verses the translation leaves out because the oldest manuscripts don't have them (such as Acts 8:37), and any real gaps. A file that reads too poorly is refused rather than half-imported.

- **Study Bibles** bring their notes, book introductions, essays and maps; the notes appear in Study's Commentary tab.
- **The words of Christ** carry over in red.
- Your imports reach your other devices through your own iCloud, and your Apple Watch when the translation's terms allow it. They are never shared with anyone else.

- Copy-protected (DRM) files are refused. The app contains no code to unlock them.

Two files known to import well

Until the ESV and CSB can be included in the app, these two editions sold or offered by their publishers import cleanly:

ESV — the Reformation Study Bible (ePub), from Ligonier Ministries. It brings the ESV text with the study Bible's notes:

store.ligonier.org/the-reformation-study-bible-esv-epub

CSB — the pew Bible (PDF), which its publisher offers as a free download:

csbible.com/.../CSB_Pew_Bible_2nd_Printing.pdf

- 1 Get the file on the device: save it to the Files app (or to your Mac). Ligonier delivers the ePub as a download in your account after purchase.
- 2 Open **Manage Translations...** and tap **Import a File...**.
- 3 Choose the file and wait for the summary. Then pick it from the translation button like any other Bible. It stays on your own devices and is never uploaded or shared.

More translations offline

The NASB 2020 and NASB 1995 are in the app by permission of The Lockman Foundation. We have asked the publishers of the ESV, CSB, NKJV and LSB for permission to include their translations too. When a license is granted, that translation will simply appear in the app, offline like the others, and the steps in this guide for it will no longer be needed.

Removing a translation

Swipe an added translation in **Manage Translations...** (or touch and hold it) and choose **Remove**. Your highlights and notes stay: they belong to the verse, not to the translation.

5

Online translations

The ESV, CSB and NKJV can be read inside Scripture Alone over the internet, using a free key from the publisher's own service. It takes about five minutes, once.

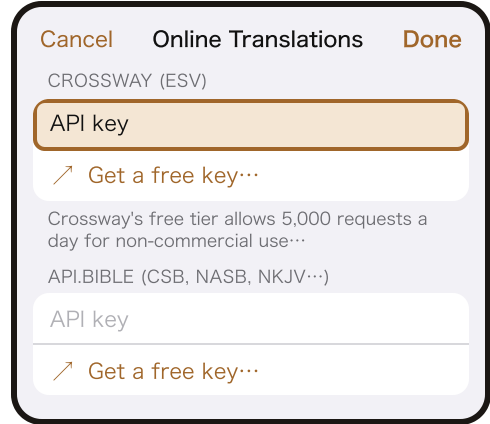
Why a key of your own? The free tiers are personal allowances. A key shipped inside the app would be used up by strangers within a day, and it would break the terms these services are offered on. Your key is stored in your device's keychain and syncs through iCloud Keychain to your other devices, end-to-end encrypted.

Service	Gives you	Free allowance
Crossway ESV API api.esv.org	English Standard Version	5,000 requests a day; up to 500 verses kept on your device
API.Bible American Bible Society	Three copyrighted translations of your choice (CSB, NKJV...), plus open ones	The free Starter plan (about 5,000 requests a month)

Both are for personal, non-commercial use, which is exactly what reading your Bible is. One person reading never comes near the limits.

The ESV, with a Crossway key

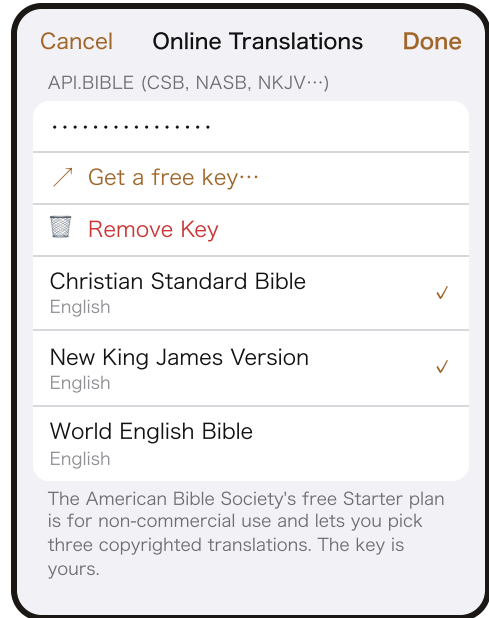
- 1 In Scripture Alone, tap the translation button, then **Manage Translations...** › **Online Translations...**.
- 2 Under **Crossway (ESV)**, tap **Get a free key...**. It opens api.esv.org.
- 3 Sign in, or create a free ESV.org account.
- 4 Fill in the short **Create Application** form. Any name works ("My Bible reading"); describe it as personal, non-commercial Bible reading in Scripture Alone, and agree to the terms.
- 5 Open your application's page and copy its **API key** (a long string of letters and numbers).
- 6 Back in Scripture Alone, paste it into **API key** under Crossway and tap **Done**.



The ESV now appears in the translation menu with an **Online** label.

The CSB and NKJV, with an API.Bible key

- 1 In **Online Translations...**, under **API.Bible**, tap **Get a free key...**. It opens api.bible.
- 2 Choose the free **Starter** plan and sign up; confirm your email.
- 3 In your API.Bible dashboard, create an app (a name and a short description of personal Bible reading are enough).
- 4 Pick your **three copyrighted Bibles** on API.Bible's site — for example the CSB and the NKJV. (Scripture Alone already includes the NASB, so there's no need to spend a pick on it.)
- 5 Copy your app's **API key**.
- 6 Paste it into **API key** under API.Bible, then tap **Check My Translations**.
- 7 Tick the translations you want in your menu and tap **Done**.



GOOD TO KNOW

- Online translations need a connection. What you read is kept on the device up to the publisher's limit, and they can't be searched offline.
- Your picks and keys come back by themselves on a new device or after reinstalling, through iCloud.
- To stop using a service, tap **Remove Key**. Its translations leave the menu; your notes and highlights stay.
- "That didn't work"? Check the key was pasted whole, with no space at either end, and that the translation is one of your picks on API.Bible's site.

Highlights, notes and favorites

Mark your Bible the way you would a paper one — and find everything again in a moment.

Highlight

Select verses and tap one of the five colors. Tap the eraser to remove a highlight.

Notes

Select verses and tap the pencil to write a note. A note can belong to several passages at once — a Sunday sermon on Romans 8:1–17 with Psalm 23 beside it, say. Notes show beside their verses as you read; tap the mark to open one.

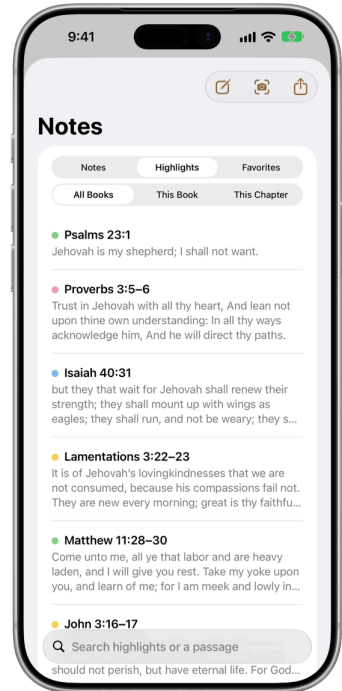
Favorites

Tap the heart in the selection bar to keep the verses you return to.

Finding them again

Tap **Notes** at the top left. The panel has three lists — **Notes**, **Highlights** and **Favorites** — each narrowing to All Books, This Book or This Chapter. Notes can be searched. Highlights are in Bible order, with neighbouring verses of one color read as one passage. Tap anything to go there; swipe to remove.

Tap **New Note** to start a note that isn't tied to a selection.



Highlights and notes

Bring your notes from another app

Open **Aa** › **Keepsake & Export** › **Bring Notes From Another App...**.

- **From Life Bible** (formerly Tecarta Bible): export everything from that app, then choose the file. Notes, highlights and saved verses come across.
- **From anywhere else:** paste your notes, or choose a CSV. Each entry should start with a reference such as "John 3:16" so it lands on the right verse.

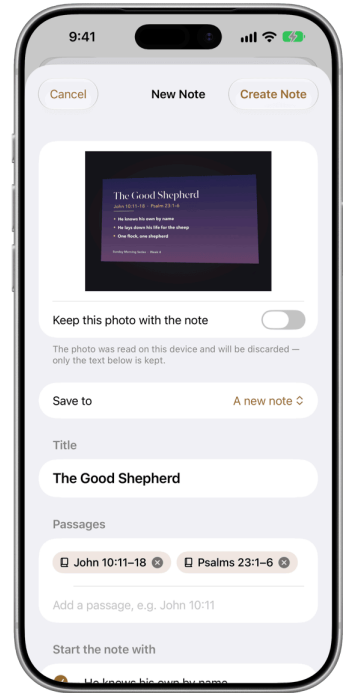
The summary shows what was found before anything is added, and importing twice is safe — nothing is duplicated. Entries that don't name a verse are listed so you can copy them over yourself.

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Sermon slides

Photograph the slide at church, and Scripture Alone starts your note: titled, linked to every passage on the slide, its points ready to fill in.

- 1 Open **Notes**, tap **Scan Slide** and choose **Take Photo of Slide** — or pick a photo you've already taken (on a Mac: an image file, the clipboard or Import from iPhone). Inside a note, **Add from Camera** adds a slide to it.
- 2 Zoom in with the zoom buttons or a pinch so the screen fills the frame, and take the photo.
- 3 The app finds the projector screen, TV or monitor in the photo, straightens it and reads only the slide. Turn off **Crop to the screen** to read the whole photo instead.
- 4 Check the title, the passages and the points, and edit anything. Choose to save to a **new note** or add to one you've started — later slides from the same sermon add to the same note.
- 5 Tap **Create Note**.



A note from a slide

PRIVATE

The photo is read on your device and never uploaded. It's thrown away afterwards unless you turn on **Keep this photo with the note**.

8 Study

Tap the open-book button at the top left to turn on Study. The Study panel follows whichever verse you tap: beside the text on iPad and Mac, in a sheet you can pull up or down on iPhone.

References

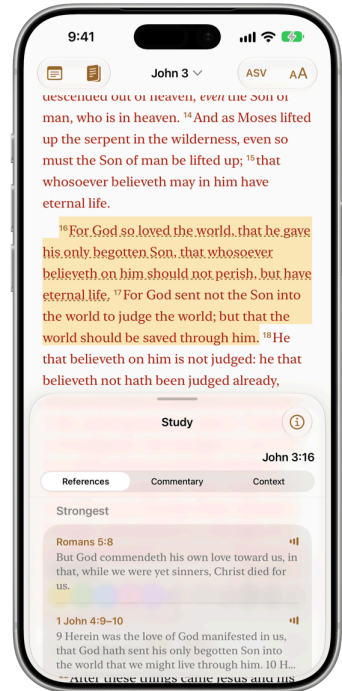
Cross references ranked by how strongly they connect, the strongest first, each shown in the translation you're reading. Tap one to go there, and the back button returns you. (From OpenBible.info.)

Commentary

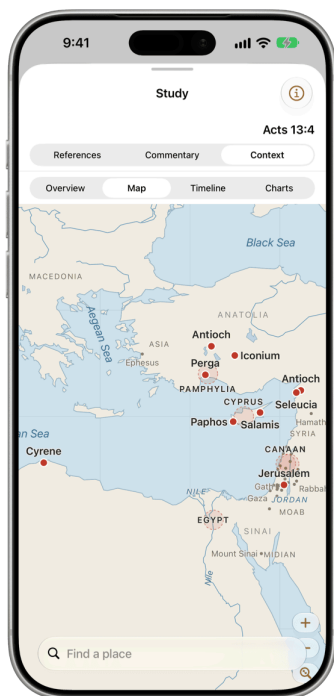
Classic commentary from John Calvin, John Gill and Jamieson, Fausset & Brown, with the references inside it linked. It downloads the first time you open the tab. An imported study Bible's notes appear here too. (Commentary is offered in English only.)

Context

For the chapter you're reading: an **Overview**; a **Map** of every place it names (tap a place for every verse that mentions it); its era on a **Timeline** of the biblical periods; and **Charts** — the kings of Israel and Judah, Paul's journeys, the twelve tribes and the feasts of Israel. The maps are drawn on your device and work without a connection.



Study, following John 3:16



Context: the places in a chapter

Original languages

Select a single verse and tap the original-language button in the selection bar. The verse appears word by word in Hebrew or Greek, with each word's parsing, its Strong's number and a lexicon entry. It works in every translation, and downloads once the first time you use it.

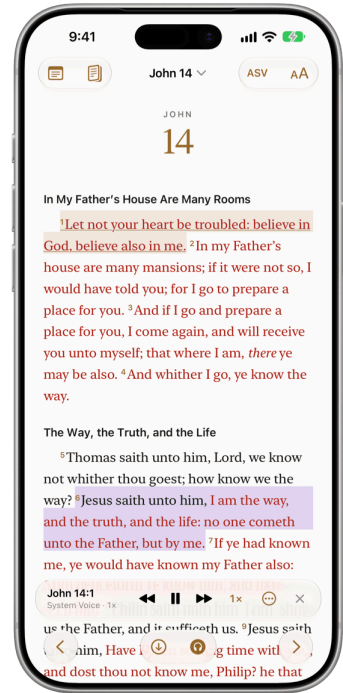
Tap the ⓘ in Study

(**About Study Resources**) to see where every resource comes from and its license.

Listen

Hear any chapter read aloud, with the spoken verse marked and kept in view.

- Tap **Listen** in the bottom bar to read from the top of the screen, or select verses and tap **Listen** in the selection bar.
- Reading carries on into the next chapter. Choose the voice, the speed and a sleep timer from the player.
- It keeps playing with the screen locked or in another app, and the lock screen has controls.
- Any voice installed on your device can read, including Premium and Enhanced voices and your Personal Voice. Download better voices in your device's Settings › Accessibility › Spoken Content.
- On iPhone and iPad, subscribers to **Mi Speaks** (a separate app) can have its Studio voices read the chapter instead.



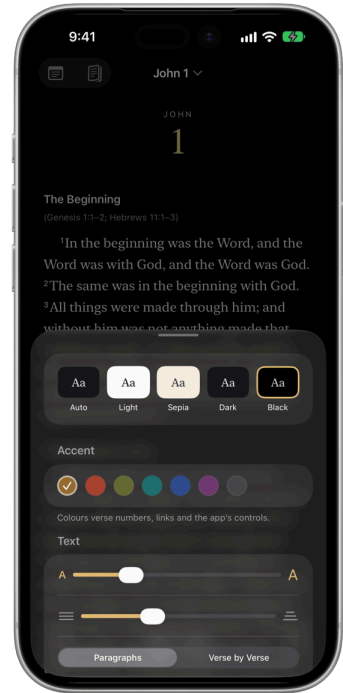
Listening

Make it yours

Tap **Aa** at the top right. Changes show at once, and they follow you to your other devices.

- **Theme:** Auto, Light, Sepia, Dark or Black, and an accent color.
- **Text:** size (or **⌕+** and **⌕-**), line spacing, and full Dynamic Type.
- **Font:** seven typefaces.
- **Layout:** paragraphs, or verse by verse; **Columns on Wide Screens** on or off.
- **Show:** Words of Christ in Red, Verse Numbers, Section Headings and Footnotes.
- **Spotlight:** let your notes and favorites appear in your device's search.
- **About This Translation:** the copyright and license of the Bible you're reading.

The same sheet holds **Keepsake & Export**, this guide, support and the app's details.



Themes and type

Share

Select verses and tap Share.

- **Verse image:** designed on your device from eight templates and three shapes (square, story, wide), in any of the reader's typefaces. Save it to Photos or send it.
- **Text:** the verses with their reference.
- **Link:** a link that rebuilds the verse card in any web browser, from the link itself. The verse travels inside the link, so no server stores it.

A scripture alone:// link or a reference like urn:osis:John.3.16 opens the passage straight in the app.



Designing a verse image

Keepsakes, family and export

Your marked Bible is worth handing down. Open **Aa** ›

Keepsake & Export.

A Keepsake Bible

- 1 Tap **Create a Keepsake**. Give it a name and a dedication ("For Sarah, from Dad"), and choose the translation it opens in.
- 2 Add a passphrase if you'd like it protected.
- 3 Give the file to your family: AirDrop, Messages, a USB drive, or kept with your will.

Family open it with **Open a Keepsake File...** and read your Bible as you marked it — read-only, kept apart from their own notes. The format is an open ZIP of JSON, so it stays readable for generations.

Share with Family

Invite family members to see your highlights, notes and favorites live, read-only, as you keep reading. Tap **Start Sharing and Invite...** and send the invitation. They see "Reading Dad's Bible • updated 5 min. ago", and can read it offline. **Stop Sharing** any time; they keep the last copy. It happens entirely between your iCloud and theirs.

Export your notes

In Notes, the **Export** menu saves all your notes, just the ones you've filtered, or a single note, as a typeset **PDF**, **Markdown** (one file or a folder) or **plain text**, with the verses quoted in your translation.

Widgets, Apple Watch, Siri and Spotlight

Widgets

Add **Verse of the Day** (365 hand-picked passages across the whole Bible) or **Favorites & Notes** to your iPhone Home and Lock Screens, your iPad or your Mac desktop. Touch and hold the Home Screen, tap **Edit** › **Add Widget**, and search for **Scripture Alone**. The verse is in the translation you're reading.

Apple Watch

The watch app has the NASB 2020 built in and reads offline, even without your iPhone nearby. It follows the translation you choose on your iPhone (the phone sends it any other Bible you read), and carries Verse of the Day, your favorites, highlights and notes, a reader and **Speak**, in the accent color you chose. Add the complication to a watch face for the day's verse.



Apple Watch

Siri and Shortcuts

Look up a verse in any translation, make a verse image, find your notes or favorites — say "Find my notes in Scripture Alone", or build your own steps in the Shortcuts app.

Spotlight

Turn on **Notes in Spotlight** and **Favorites in Spotlight** under **Aa** to find them from your device's search.

Sync and privacy

- No ads, no trackers, no analytics and no account. There is no server of ours holding your data — not now, not ever.
- Your highlights, notes, favorites, reading position and settings sync only through **your own iCloud**. Make sure iCloud is on for Scripture Alone in your device's Settings.
- API keys you enter sync through iCloud Keychain, end-to-end encrypted.
- Imported Bibles reach your own devices through your iCloud, and nobody else's.
- Sermon slides and verse images are processed on your device.
- Keepsakes are files you hand over yourself; Share with Family only starts when you tap it, and Stop Sharing deletes the shared copy.
- Scripture Alone is open source (AGPL), so anyone can read exactly what it does: github.com/blaineam/Scripture-Alone.

NASB 2020 and NASB 1995 © The Lockman Foundation. Used by permission. www.Lockman.org
 ESV® is a registered trademark of Crossway. CSB® is a registered trademark of Holman Bible Publishers.
 NKJV © Thomas Nelson.

Scripture Alone is not affiliated with Ligonier Ministries, Crossway, the American Bible Society or any publisher named in this guide.

Questions and answers

Does it work without internet?

Yes. The NASB 2020 is built in, and anything you download or import stays available offline. Only online translations (chapter 5) need a connection.

A Bible is still downloading. Can I read?

Yes — read the NASB 2020 while it finishes. If a download fails, a banner offers **Try Again**.

Why isn't the ESV, CSB or NKJV just included?

Those translations belong to their publishers, and including them takes a license. We've asked for one. Meanwhile, read them with your own key (chapter 5) or import a copy you own (chapter 4).

My notes aren't on my other device.

Check that both devices are signed in to the same Apple Account with iCloud turned on for Scripture Alone, and give them a minute on Wi-Fi.

An import says it has gaps.

Some translations genuinely leave out verses, and some files are simply incomplete. You can read whatever imported either way; a cleaner edition of the file usually fixes it.

Is it really free?

Yes: no purchases, no subscriptions, no ads. It was built to help people study God's word and grow closer to Christ.

Where can I get help?

Visit wemiller.com/apps/scripture-alone, or use Support under **Aa**.